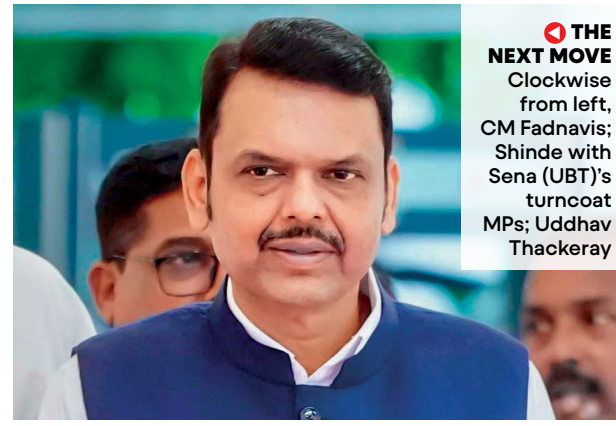
STATE SCAN

BENGAL: NEW ROAD TO INDUSTRIALISATION *PG 19*

PUNJAB: TAKHT HAS THE LAST WORD *PG 20*



MANDAR DEODHAR



ANI

THE NEXT MOVE Clockwise from left, CM Fadnavis; Shinde with Sena (UBT)'s turncoat MPs; Uddhav Thackeray



PTI

MAHARASHTRA

MAHAYUTI IN A MAHA CHURN

The sweep in the state legislative council election was supposed to cement the ruling BJP-led alliance's position. Instead, it has exposed the cracks among the partners

By **Dhaval S. Kulkarni**

ON THE FACE OF IT, THE RULING MAHAYUTI ALLIANCE in Maharashtra seems unassailable. The defection of six out of nine Lok Sabha MPs from the Opposition Shiv Sena (Uddhav Balasaheb Thackeray) to the Shiv Sena led by deputy chief minister Eknath Shinde, and the rumours of another split in the party's legislature unit in Maharashtra—along with one in the Nationalist Congress Party (Sharadchandra Pawar) ranks—have created a flutter in the already demoralised Opposition camp.

But, as many in the Mahayuti alliance admit, the Devendra Fadnavis-led government is dealing with a crisis of its own. The meltdown in the Opposition Maha Vikas Aghadi (MVA) has seen a parallel rise in sniping among the allies in the